SETUP CHECKLIST · OCTOBER 2026

FROM ZERO TO LIVE

The corrected starting state and the complete setup order. Three things are already live — the site, Cloudflare, and email. Twenty-seven steps remain, in order, each with a tick-box and a pointer to its full instructions. Print it, pin it up, and work it top to bottom.

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COMPANION TO THE PRODUCTION FLIGHT PLAN

The True Starting Line

This sheet exists because the earlier state table blurred two different things: what has been **built** and what you have **set up**. The built side is finished — the code, the tests, the copy. The set-up side is at zero. As of today, exactly three things are live, and they are listed below with filled boxes. Everything else — every record, every install, every profile, every send — has not been started, and that is fine: this is the starting line, not a backlog of failures. The twenty-seven open boxes below are the whole distance between here and production, in the order they should be done.

Use it simply. Work the boxes top to bottom. Do not start a later phase before its earlier one — the order protects you, because the factory assumes the site is fixed and the outreach assumes the email is warm. Every row points at the document where its full instructions already live, so nothing here is new to write or figure out: the Production Flight Plan is the manual, and this sheet is the tick-box version of it. Print it, pin it above the desk next to the cheat sheet, and mark each box as it lands.

Done	What is already standing	Status
☑	Website — mikebuilds.tech live on Cloudflare Pages: the porch plus the three hidden doors, www redirecting to apex, HTTPS on	LIVE (serving the v4 build; Step 1 swaps in the fix)
☑	Cloudflare — the account, the DNS zone, and the Pages project serving the domain	LIVE
☑	Email — Zoho mailboxes mike@, hello@, quotes@ plus the catch-all tracking aliases	LIVE (DNS records and warmup are still to do — Steps 3 and 4)

Table 1 — Already standing: the site, the domain plumbing, and the mail.

3 done · 27 boxes · 1 clock

The only thing on a calendar is the 14-day email warmup — every other box moves as fast as you do

Phase 0 — Today: Ship the Fix and Start the Clock

This is the highest-leverage hour in the whole plan. The redeploy repairs the two live site bugs in about thirty minutes with a one-click rollback if anything looks wrong, and the three DNS records stop your domain mail from landing in spam by default. The warmup sends then start the only clock in the stack: fourteen days of small, honest volume. Nothing in this hour requires anything to be installed first — no Docker, no n8n, no credentials beyond the Cloudflare login you already have.

Box	Step (do them in order)	Full instructions	Time
☐	**1.** Redeploy the v5 site build — repairs the invisible /realtor grid and the off-center TEXT MIKE button on every door page	website-package-v5/REDEPLOY-GUIDE.md · Flight Plan Ch 3	~30 min
☐	**2.** Run the 5-line phone check on real Wi-Fi and on your phone	REDEPLOY-GUIDE.md Step 5 · Flight Plan Ch 3	~10 min
☐	**3.** Add the three email DNS records in Cloudflare: SPF, DKIM, and DMARC	Flight Plan Ch 4	~15 min
☐	**4.** Warmup Day 1 — send two or three short personal notes from mike@ to people who will reply	Flight Plan Ch 4	~5 min

Table 2 — Phase 0, about one hour, all of it today.

Phase 1 — Day 1–2: Install the Factory (One Afternoon)

Charm City Sites is the website factory that finds Baltimore plumbers, builds them demo sites, deploys them, emails them, and follows up. Everything except two credentials is paste-in wiring: a Cloudflare API token (which does the deploying) and an email app password (which does the sending). Budget one focused afternoon — roughly fifteen minutes of installer waiting, about forty-five minutes of credential wiring, then the test drive. When the Telegram bot answers SITE LIVE with a real pages.dev URL, the factory is proven on your own machine.

Box	Step (do them in order)	Full instructions	Time
☐	**5.** Install Docker Desktop with the WSL2 backend (the single most leveraged click in the plan)	Flight Plan Ch 5	~20 min
☐	**6.** Run 1-INSTALL-WINDOWS.bat; create the n8n owner login when the browser opens localhost:5678	Flight Plan Ch 5	~20 min
☐	**7.** Build the control spreadsheet — new Google Sheet, Leads and Settings tabs, import the kit CSVs	Flight Plan Ch 5	~10 min
☐	**8.** Create the fresh Gmail; turn on 2-Step Verification; generate the 16-character app password	Flight Plan Ch 5	~10 min
☐	**9.** Wire the four n8n credentials — Google Sheets OAuth2 is the fiddly one, about 10 minutes	Flight Plan Ch 5	~45 min
☐	**10.** Import the five workflows in order; assign credentials to every red node; activate	Flight Plan Ch 5	~30 min

Box	Step (do them in order)	Full instructions	Time
☐	**11.** Paste the Cloudflare API token, account ID, and FreeLLMAPI key into factory/env.sh	Flight Plan Ch 5	~5 min
☐	**12.** Fill the Settings tab; set the two power options (sleep never, lid close do nothing)	Flight Plan Ch 5	~10 min
☐	**13.** Test drive — message the Telegram bot the add command for Fells Point Test Plumbing; SITE LIVE replies with a real pages.dev URL	Flight Plan Ch 5	~5 min

Table 3 — The factory install, in the order the kit's own documentation prints it.

Phase 2 — Day 2–3: The Engine's Two Nights

AssetForge turns long video into provenance-checked content packs. It is one honest gate away from being a working business asset, and the gate is two evenings. You start each night, you sleep, you read the verdict in the morning: Night 1 proves the install with a tiny synthetic job, and Night 2 proves the business with one real two-hour episode. The Windows laptop transcribes on CPU in hours, which is expected and documented; that is exactly why the overnight window exists. Neither night asks you to sit through anything.

Box	Step (do them in order)	Full instructions	Time
☐	**14.** Night 1 — run setup-windows.ps1, then the af smoke test (one tiny end-to-end job)	Flight Plan Ch 6 · AssetForge HANDOFF.md	~25 min + wait
☐	**15.** Night 2 — submit one real two-hour episode before bed; read the pack like a customer in the morning	Flight Plan Ch 6	overnight

Table 4 — Two gates, deliberately human, each witnessed from a distance.

Phase 3 — Day 3–7: Paste Lane B Live

Lane B is the cash-now lane: Fiverr, Upwork, and the free local channels. Every asset is already written to the character limit — gig titles, package tiers, tags, FAQs, the profile blurbs, the five-line proposal formula, the Instagram captions. This phase is pure paste-and-post, spread across a few evenings while the email warms in the background. None of it blocks the other phases; it exists to profit from the dead time the warmup creates.

Box	Step (do them in order)	Full instructions	Time
☐	**16.** Fiverr — create the seller account with the written profile blurb; publish the three written gigs exactly as they are	Flight Plan Ch 7 · copyblocks file	one evening
☐	**17.** Upwork — set the profile; send the first tailored five-line proposals	Flight Plan Ch 7	one evening
☐	**18.** Google Business Profile — create and verify (brand details, mike@ address, 410-575-4192)	Flight Plan Ch 7	~30 min
☐	**19.** Join Alignable, Nextdoor, and the local Facebook groups; introduce once, be present weekly	Flight Plan Ch 7	~30 min
☐	**20.** Post Instagram caption 1 (written at full length, hashtags included)	Flight Plan Ch 7	~10 min
☐	**21.** Warmup sends, daily, on the ramp — the numbers are in the Phase 1 table of the plan	Flight Plan Ch 4	~5 min/day

Table 5 — Lane B channels mapped to the evenings that paste them live.

Phase 4 — Day 8–13: Hold the Ramp

Nothing new gets built this week. The sender's reputation is the only thing on the schedule, and it grows at its own pace: ten to fifteen personalized sends a day, replies answered, opt-outs honored permanently. The useful dead-time filler is the printing queue — the cheat sheet to pin up and the three flyers to place where tradesmen actually wait. Both are print-ready files in the traffic kit; sending them to a print shop is a ten-minute errand that keeps working for months.

Box	Step (do them in order)	Full instructions	Time
☐	**22.** Keep the daily warmup sends — 10 to 15 personalized per day by now	Flight Plan Ch 4	~5 min/day
☐	**23.** Send the cheat sheet and the three flyers to a print shop; drop flyers where tradesmen wait	traffic-kit/ folder	whenever

Table 6 — The quiet week: warm the sender, seed the street.

Phase 5 — Day 14: Open the Taps

Fourteen days after Step 4, the senders are warm, the records are live, and the caps open. This is the moment the whole stack was aimed at: the factory gets real lead rows and starts building uninvited demo sites for

Baltimore plumbers, sending each one its plain-spoken note. The 45-day Charm City window starts on the first real outreach row — not on install day — so the clock that matters begins exactly here. Your entire contribution is the part machines are bad at: when a plumber replies, the call that closes the sale is yours the same day.

Box	Step (do them in order)	Full instructions	Time
☐	**24.** Caps open — feed the factory its first real lead rows from the morning report or your own neighborhood knowledge	Flight Plan Ch 8	~30 min
☐	**25.** Same-day callbacks on every reply ping — the voice close is yours	Flight Plan Ch 8	daily
☐	**26.** One-word /status replies on won and dead deals; the invoice and the upsell fire automatically after that	Flight Plan Ch 8	under 1 min each

Table 7 — Launch day: feed the machine, answer the phone.

Every Day After: The Rhythm

Once every phase is live, the whole operating cadence is fifteen minutes a day, and it fits around school. The Telegram morning report at 09:00 tells you who was emailed, who replied, and what needs a decision; reply pings arrive the moment they land; won and dead deals each get a one-word status reply. The weekly hour reviews the dead rows, refreshes the Lane B profiles, posts one caption, and checks gig standings. Everything else — the scraping, the building, the deploying, the sending, the invoicing, the follow-ups — is the machine's job.

Box	Step (do them in order)	Full instructions	Time
☐	**27.** The daily loop — read the 09:00 Telegram report, call back the repliers, one-word statuses, forward hot form leads	Flight Plan Ch 9	~15 min

Table 8 — The steady-state job. Everything else is the machine's.

When a Box Will Not Tick

Every failure mode in this plan already has a written answer, and none of them is a dead end. The table below maps the four you are most likely to meet in the first two weeks to the document that already handles it. The rule underneath all of them is the change protocol: fixes and changes belong in the conversation that owns that machine, made in its source, then re-gated — never patched sideways. That rule is what keeps four

moving parts from quietly colliding while nobody is watching.

When a box will not tick	What to do	Where it is written
The site looks wrong after the redeploy	Pages project, Deployments tab, find the previous deployment, Promote to production. One click, zero risk.	REDEPLOY-GUIDE.md Step 6
SITE LIVE never arrives after the test drive	The three usual suspects, in order: n8n not up (Start Factory .bat), the Cloudflare token wrong in factory/env.sh, the sheet tab named incorrectly.	OPERATIONS.md in the Charm City bundle
The af smoke test fails	Restart the Ollama tray app once, then rerun. If it still fails, the escalation path is the hardware-honesty doc; every stage is resumable.	AssetForge HANDOFF.md + windows-bridge doc
You want to change a machine	Take it to that project's own conversation — never patch it sideways from another thread.	Flight Plan Ch 10, the change protocol

Table 9 — The escape hatches, and where each one is written down.